

The intricate interplay between human consciousness and the mysteries of perception has always fascinated me. From the remarkable awareness of a well-lit room to the physiological reactions it triggers, humans possess a unique level of consciousness, distinct from that of a simple plant reacting to its environment. This captivating distinction has fueled my profound interest in the convergence of neuroscience and psychology.

My journey into this fascinating field has been marked by enlightening moments. A recent TED talk on Cranial Electrotherapy Stimulation's potential in treating mental illnesses, such as PTSD, reinforced my belief in the symbiotic relationship between neuroscience and psychology. The Bath Literature Festival's presentation on 'The Wisdom of Psychopaths' shed light on the role of epigenetics in the age-old nature versus nurture debate.

One of the most compelling questions I've encountered pertains to the influence of environmental factors on cognitive development. This led me to ponder the extent to which this applies to the most basic model of a brain conducting simple cognitive processes, akin to a computer. As President of my college's Psychology Society, I've organized enlightening talks by professionals in related fields, stimulating discussions on topics like non-human primates' potential theory of mind.

My Extended Essay delves into applying psychological research and theory to understand violent behavior within hierarchical constructs, exemplified by the Abu Ghraib prison abuses. This experience has emphasized the importance of a holistic approach to psychological research.

Conducting my own experiment has revealed both the strengths and limitations of the scientific method, particularly when quantifying subjective phenomena such as memory. I firmly believe in the potential of modern scientific techniques, including brain imaging technology, to provide fresh insights into age-old questions, such as the nature of morality.

My exploration of the psychology of moral decisions, particularly the research conducted at Harvard University on the psychological factors influencing choices in dilemmas like the 'Trolley Dilemma,' has been truly captivating. The ongoing debate regarding the interplay of reason and emotion in forming moral judgments continues to intrigue me.

Studying Theory of Knowledge has honed my ability to question interpretations of situations and think independently, unraveling my thought processes. My IB coursework has refined my research, critical analysis, and argument evaluation skills.

As a prefect, I've garnered invaluable leadership insights, particularly during my participation in the GDST Young Leaders' Conference. Commitment, focus, and practice have been my guiding principles, reinforced through my dedication to karate and long-distance running.

The dynamic field of psychology is rapidly evolving, and I am exhilarated by the prospect of contributing to future research that may reshape our understanding of cognition, behavior, and social interactions, thereby revolutionizing our perspective on the world around us.